

the media estate

one funnel, nine surfaces — whistlegraph → Aesthetic.Computer

@jeffrey · July 2026 · planning hub: /social in the monorepo

two brands. one funnel

@**whistlegraph** is the established audience; @**aesthetic.computer** is the growth target. The funnel runs one way — “made with aesthetic.computer” posts, never an audience merge.

	whistlegraph	aesthetic.computer
TikTok	2.6M followers · 99M likes	391 followers
YouTube	5,340 subs · 2.1M views	4 subs · 70 views
Instagram	(established; count TODO)	under 1k — <i>the gate that matters</i>
Posting since	dormant since ~2023	just beginning

- The audience already exists — the whistlegraph archive still moves ~**48,000 video views per day** with zero new posts.
- The problem is not reach. It is that **the pipe between the brands is not connected**, and most surfaces cannot be posted to by script yet.

twelve accounts. nine surfaces

Tracked in `social/accounts.json`; strategy and tooling index in `social/SCORE.md`.

Account	Surface	Role	Standing
@aesthetic.computer	Instagram	primary growth target	under 1k
@aesthetic.computer	TikTok	primary growth target	391 followers
Aesthetic Dot Computer	YouTube	music + readings archive	4 subs
@aesthetic.computer	Bluesky	changelog + paintings feed	81 followers
AC Readings	Podcast	essays → Spotify/Apple/YT	stats TODO
@promptDOTac	X	dormant brand outlet	revive by mirror
Aesthetic Dot Computer	Spotify artist	distribution via DistroKid	claim blocked
@whistlegraph	TikTok	funnel source	2.6M followers
@whistlegraph	YouTube	funnel source	5.3k subs
@whistlegraph	Instagram	funnel source	count TODO
@whistlegraph	X	dormant funnel	count TODO
(jeffrey)	Are.na	curation surface	token not vaulted

what the archive says

Top whistlegraph YouTube videos (of 210 uploads, 2.1M total views, pulled 2026-07-05):

Views	Video	Era
245k	mommy wow WHISTLING GRAPHIX	2021 lo-fi chalk originals
213k	zigzag x circle, i love mommy wow	2021 lo-fi chalk originals
108k	The Longest Whistlegraph Ever	2022 relatable-caption era
83k	seasons changing	2022 relatable-caption era
65k	hey, are you from LA?	2022 relatable-caption era

- The **lo-fi, process-visible originals** massively outperform — the audience came for watching a form being made, not for polish.
- Nothing posted since 2023, and the numbers held. **Dormant is not dead.**
- This is the exact premise Aesthetic.Computer content should lead with: *the making, not the made.*

access today

Can we post to it by script, from the monorepo, right now?

Surface	Access	Via	Gap
YouTube (both channels)	full	toolchain/youtube/yt.mjs	quota: 6 uploads/day
Bluesky	full	at/ scripts, app password	—
Podcast (Buzzsprout)	full	reading skill	stats pull
Papers / essays	full	self-hosted, no gatekeeper	—
Instagram (both)	partial	read-only unofficial sessions	no publish at all
TikTok (both)	partial	OAuth app in silo; ingest only	unaudited: no publish
Spotify (music)	partial	DistroKid semi-automated	artist claim blocked
Are.na	partial	proven gig scripts	token not vaulted
X (both)	none	—	no developer app

The scripted surfaces are the quiet ones; **the loud surfaces are all manual**. That asymmetry is the whole build-out.

instagram pays three ways

One build-out — official publishing via the Instagram API with Instagram Login (no Facebook Page; own accounts publish in dev mode, no app review) — unlocks three separate outcomes:

1. **The 1k gate.** Scripted reels at cadence are the only realistic path to 1,000 followers on @aesthetic.computer — which unlocks **Trial Reels** (test on non-followers, promote winners). A hard gate, not a soft one.
2. **The funnel.** Same tooling posts “made with aesthetic.computer” re-cuts to @whistlegraph — the 2.6M-audience bridge, finally scriptable.
3. **The Spotify claim.** The Spotify for Artists verification has been **blocked since May** on one thing: a trancenwaltz post live on the @aesthetic.computer grid. First API-published post un-blocks the waiting draft reply (pop/spotify-for-artists-claim-reply.md).

Detail that shapes the tooling: IG publish takes a **public video URL**, not a file upload — our DO Spaces CDN feeds it, so the CLI pushes to Spaces first.

the mills already run

Every surface has a content mill behind it in the monorepo — production is not the bottleneck.

Pipeline	Produces	Lands on
pop/ music mill	tracks + visualizers + 9:16 cuts	DistroKid, YouTube, reels
marketing/kidlisp-reels/	KidLisp process reels, 9:16	IG + TikTok at-bats
recap/	narrated vertical video	IG + TikTok
papers/ → readings	essays + spoken audio	site, Buzzsprout, Spotify, Apple
at/ scripts	changelog threads, paintings	Bluesky (X mirror next)
whistlegraph archive	950+ TikToks, 193 videos	re-cut fodder for funnel posts

- One edit, many surfaces: the same 9:16 short goes to IG Reels and TikTok every time.
- The archive is a **library, not a museum** — top performers become funnel re-cuts.

api access. in value order

1. **Instagram official publishing** — Meta app + Instagram Login; then `ig.mjs` in the toolchain, same shape as `yt.mjs`. *The keystone.*
2. **X developer app** — free tier covers a mirror cadence; `x.mjs` posts the same short drops as Bluesky.
3. **TikTok Content Posting audit** — the OAuth app already exists in silo; an approved audit makes the 2.6M-follower account scriptable.
4. **Are.na token to the vault** — scripts already speak the API.
5. **Buzzsprout stats** — wire downloads into `accounts.json` snapshots.
6. **YouTube quota bump** — when cadence outgrows six uploads a day.

Done already: YouTube both channels (2026-07-05) · Bluesky · Buzzsprout publish · papers.

Every unlock lands as a CLI in the same idiom — vault-held tokens, `--as <channel>` identity switching, private-first defaults.

lead with the making

Positioning. Aesthetic.Computer is the hand-built-instrument brand: *“I made the tool that made this.”* Visible authorship — KidLisp coming together, a synth answering live — inoculates against the AI-slop read. The archive evidence (slide 4) says this is also simply what the audience rewards.

Cadence. 4–7 process-over-product shorts a week; below 1k a flop costs nothing — every reel is an at-bat. One repeatable series people can anticipate.

Funnel discipline. @whistlegraph stays its own voice; it tags, it never merges. Music ships as Aesthetic Dot Computer; papers and readings ship as @jeffrey.

Never: follow/unfollow churn, engagement pods, bought followers — they poison the non-follower targeting that Trial Reels and the algorithm both depend on.

four portal sessions

Each unlock needs one short human session at a developer portal — everything after is scripted:

1. **Meta app** (developers.facebook.com) — connect both IG professional accounts, hand back app id, secret, and two long-lived tokens. *~15 min.*
2. **X developer account** (developer.x.com) — create the app under the brand owner. *~10 min.*
3. **TikTok audit application** — submit the Content Posting API review on the existing silo app. *~15 min + wait.*
4. **Are.na token** — generate once, vault it. *~2 min.*

Planning hub: `social/SCORE.md` + `social/accounts.json` — append a dated snapshot whenever fresh numbers are pulled; every new tool gets a row in the index so `/social` stays the single front door.

This deck: `papers/deck-media-estate/` — the first entry in the papers decks lane.